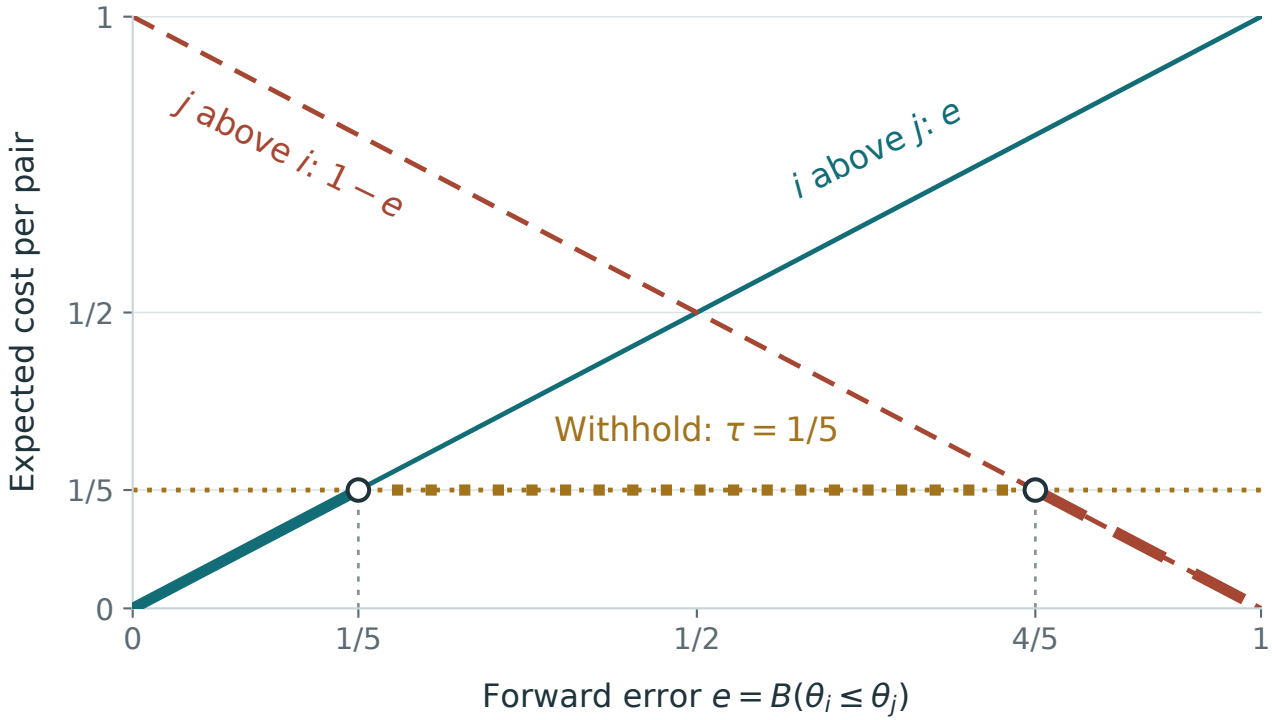
The isolated-pair decision

One scalar pair; no latent ties. Cost per unordered pair (M = 1).



Thick segments: minimum cost

i above *j*	Withhold	*j* above *i*
$e < 1/5$	$1/5 < e < 4/5$	$e > 4/5$

At e = 1/5: i above j and withhold.
At e = 4/5: j above i and withhold.

Normalized source parameter

$\tau = \lambda/(1+\lambda)$
$\lambda = \tau/(1-\tau)$

$\tau = 1/5 \iff \lambda = 1/4$

Endpoint $\tau = 1/2$
At $e = 1/2$:
$e = 1 - e = \tau = 1/2$
All three actions minimize.

These are local pair decisions. Coherent common grades can require a different pair action.

Withholding is a report action; it does not assert equal latent targets.